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Indian Institute of Management Udaipur

DateNest

Personal Life Management System

Team NorthStar Cue | Where every important date finds its home.

One app. Every date. Zero missed deadlines.

Executive Education | Executive Program in Product Management (EPPM) | IIM Udaipur

Document Information	Details
Programme	Executive Program in Product Management (EPPM) - IIM Udaipur
Academic Year	2026-27
Team	NorthStar Cue
Team Members	Lovelesh Gupta; Janvi Shrimali
Guided Mentors	Prof. Rajesh R. Nanarpuzha; Malthi SS
Purpose	Capstone Concept Note - Academic Submission & Presentation

PRODUCT THESIS
DateNest combines the date, relevant context, a preparation window and the next action - rather than treating every important event as a generic reminder.

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01 | Problem & Product Opportunity

People manage recurring personal, financial, household and family obligations across calendars, chats, emails, documents and service-specific apps. The problem is not simply forgetting a date; it is remembering too late to act.

Current situation	User impact	Product opportunity
Dates are fragmented across calendars, chats, emails, documents and service apps.	Higher mental load and greater risk of forgetting.	Create one structured home for important life dates.
Generic events often contain only a title and date.	Amount, reference number, relationship or required action may be missing.	Attach only the context relevant to the event category.
A reminder may arrive on or near the due date.	There may be insufficient time to arrange money, documents or plans.	Use a preparation-oriented Reminder Ladder.

People managing personal, financial, civic and family responsibilities need a simple way to consolidate important life dates, retain the context needed to act, and receive enough advance notice to prepare before a deadline becomes a problem.

02 | Research Evidence

Secondary research supports problem relevance, but it does not establish India-specific market size, willingness to pay or product-market fit. Those questions require primary research.

Source	Evidence	Implication
YouGov (2024)	Survey of 3,329 adults in Great Britain: 10% said they forget other people's birthdays very often and 27% fairly often.	Forgetting important personal dates is a recognizable consumer problem.
Moonpig commissioned research	61% of surveyed Britons said they forget birthdays/anniversaries because they have so much going on; 45% of 16-29-year-olds said they had forgotten a parent's birthday.	Supports the life-overload hypothesis; use cautiously because the study was commissioned by a gifting company.
Microsoft Research (2017)	Research on digital reminder systems found people want support remembering a broad range of future activities and retrieving contextual details.	Supports storing context alongside dates rather than treating every reminder as generic.

03 | Target Users & Competitive Context

Segment	Typical needs	Potential value
Students & young adults	Fees, rent, exams, first financial obligations, family dates.	Simple setup and clear reminders.
Working professionals	EMIs, insurance, investments, vehicle service, family dates.	One place for recurring obligations.
Families / household managers	Bills, appointments, school fees, service dates, family occasions.	Shared visibility and useful context.
Older adults and caregivers	Renewals, appointments, insurance and family events.	Simple, dependable reminders.

Capability	Google Calendar	Any.do	TimelyBills / Axio	DateNest opportunity
Generic calendar / tasks	Strong	Strong	Finance-focused	Do not compete head-on
Generic reminders	Yes	Yes	Yes	Table stakes
Life-event structure	Generic	General-purpose	Finance-focused	Core experience
Context attached to event	Basic	Task-oriented	Finance-oriented	Category-specific fields
Preparation-oriented timing	Configurable	Recurring	Reminder-focused	Make timing + context central
India-aware use cases	General	General	Finance / India-focused	Specialize where useful and validate

POSITIONING STATEMENT
DateNest is a personal life-event management system that helps people remember what matters, understand why it matters, and prepare before the date arrives.

04 | Product Concept

DateNest should not be positioned as another generic reminder or task-management app. Its proposed differentiation is the life-event model: date + context + preparation window + next action.

Entry mode	How it works	User value
Guided entry	Ask only for fields relevant to the selected category.	Structured setup without a complex form.
Manual entry	Create a custom date and choose a reminder pattern.	Flexibility for personal use.
Connected entry - future hypothesis	Surface relevant dates from permitted sources for user confirmation.	Less typing, subject to consent and feasibility.

05 | MVP Scope

Category	Examples	Useful context
Insurance & Policy	Life, health, vehicle, term insurance	Policy number, renewal date, premium, vehicle
Finance & Bills	EMIs, credit cards, utilities, recurring payments	Amount, due date, account/reference, recurrence
Personal & Family	Birthdays, anniversaries, family milestones	Person, relationship, date, notes
Home & Maintenance	Rent, car service, appliance and household services	Provider, recurrence, amount, notes

06 | Core Feature - Reminder Ladder

The Reminder Ladder is the central product hypothesis. It is not designed to increase notification volume; it is designed to create a useful preparation window appropriate to the life event.

Timing	Purpose	Example intent
30 days before	Preparation	Keep funds, documents or plans ready
7 days before	Awareness	Review details and preparation needed
3 days before	Action	Urgent nudge + clear next step
1 day before	Final reminder	Make the deadline difficult to overlook
On the day	Action prompt	Mark done, snooze or take the next action
3 days after	Follow-up	Check completion where appropriate

DESIGN PRINCIPLE
The ladder should be configurable by category. A birthday may need a different cadence from an insurance renewal or a bill. Optimize for useful preparation, not notification volume.

07 | Value Moment

Illustrative example: a user adds a LIC premium of ₹12,000 due on 15 July. DateNest surfaces the event early, keeps policy context attached and progressively shifts the reminder from preparation to action. The same model can support a family birthday, credit-card bill or vehicle insurance renewal - with different context and cadence.

08 | Validation Plan

Stage	What we test	Decision evidence
Problem interviews	How people currently remember important dates and where failures occur.	Frequency, consequence and current workarounds.
Concept test	Whether date + context + preparation window is understood as useful.	Comprehension and stated value.
Prototype test	Reminder Ladder versus a generic single reminder.	Preference, task completion and errors.
MVP pilot	Whether users repeatedly add and act on meaningful dates.	Activation, reminder response and retention.

09 | Success Metrics

Metric	Type	What it tells us
Users who act on at least one important reminder each week	North Star candidate	Whether reminders lead to meaningful action.
Dates added in first session	Leading	Whether the product creates initial value.
Reminder response and completion rate	Leading	Whether alerts are useful and actionable.
Week 1 and Day 30 retention	Lagging	Whether DateNest becomes part of a routine.
Self-reported reduction in missed dates	Outcome	Whether the product reduces the problem it targets.

10 | Roadmap

Phase	Scope	Outcome
Phase 1 - Validate and MVP	Interviews, four core categories, manual/guided entry, Reminder Ladder, upcoming-date dashboard.	Prove users understand and value the core concept.
Phase 2 - Pilot and Learn	Selected connected-source experiments, family sharing, widgets and India-specific date packs where validated.	Improve retention, trust and convenience.
Phase 3 - Scale	Broader integrations, multilingual support, smarter suggestions and ecosystem partnerships.	Scale only the validated product model.

11 | Risks & Guardrails

Risk	Guardrail
Notification fatigue	Configurable cadence, snooze/mute controls and measurement of reminder usefulness.
Trust & privacy	Explicit consent, minimum data collection and transparent permissions.
Over-broad positioning	Start with high-value life-event categories; expand only from evidence.
Integration dependency	Treat connected sources as hypotheses until technically and legally feasible.

12 | Why DateNest?

The product-management opportunity is not the reminder itself. It is the set of decisions around user segmentation, life-event information architecture, contextual data, notification design, trust, prioritisation and measurable outcomes.

DateNest becomes meaningful if it can move a user from “I know this date is coming” to “I had enough time and context to do something about it.” That is the product outcome worth validating.

13 | Conclusion

> **CORE PROPOSITION**
> **Bring important dates together. Add the context needed to act. Give people enough time to prepare.**

DateNest is intentionally presented as a product hypothesis, not a claim of proven product-market fit. The next stage is to validate the problem with users, test the core experience and use evidence to define the smallest product that creates measurable value.

14 | References & Research Sources

YouGov - Birthday forgetting survey (3 September 2024) - Survey of 3,329 adults in Great Britain on how often people forget other people's birthdays.

Moonpig Group - Research on forgetting birthdays and anniversaries - Commissioned research on why birthdays and anniversaries are forgotten; used cautiously as directional evidence.

Microsoft Research - Remember, Remember: Exploring Possibilities for Digital Reminder Systems (2017) - Research on digital reminder systems, including the need to remember future activities and retrieve contextual details.

IIM Udaipur Faculty Directory - Prof. Rajesh R. Nanarpuzha - Official IIM Udaipur faculty profile used for academic reference verification.

> **ACADEMIC NOTE**
> **Market and user-behaviour claims are treated as hypotheses unless supported by primary research. The capstone should use interviews and usability testing to validate demand, behaviour and MVP scope.**